CHAPTER ONE

1.1 INTRODUCTION

Nigeria has experienced exponential growth in digital connectivity with over 109 million internet users and approximately 48 million active social media accounts as of 2024. Platforms such as WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook and X serve as primary channels for communication, education, commerce and social engagement among young Nigerians. However, this rapid adoption has intensified exposure to privacy incidents including data breaches, impersonation, cyberbullying, doxxing and unsolicited surveillance.

Existing privacy frameworks such as Solove's Taxonomy of Privacy and Solove and Citron's Typology of Privacy Harms were developed within Western legal traditions that prioritise acute, tangible and legally provable harms. Recent empirical work demonstrates that most privacy violations experienced by ordinary users result in psychological distress, loss of psychological safety, persistent paranoia and emotional fatigue rather than immediate financial or physical damage. These lived harms remain largely unaddressed by current regulatory instruments including the Nigeria Data Protection Regulation 2019 and the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 which focus primarily on organisational compliance and measurable losses.

Research on youth online safety reveals significant communication gaps between platform claims about safety features and their actual effectiveness, while expert evaluations highlight tensions in implementing risk detection technologies including privacy dilemmas and sustainability challenges. These insights underscore the need for context sensitive tools that empower users to document and classify their privacy experiences in ways that reflect local realities.

This project responds to this gap by developing a web based Privacy Incident Reporting System integrated with an adapted sociotechnical taxonomy of lived privacy harms tailored for Nigerian university students. The system will enable users to report incidents, classify associated harms using locally relevant categories, and access basic guidance for mitigation and escalation.

1.2 STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Nigerian university students frequently encounter privacy incidents on social media platforms yet lack accessible, culturally appropriate mechanisms to document, classify and report these experiences. Current frameworks and reporting channels emphasise tangible harms such as financial loss or physical injury while neglecting psychological, emotional and relational impacts that constitute the majority of lived privacy harms according to recent empirical studies.

Three interrelated challenges exacerbate this situation. First, existing taxonomies do not adequately capture the sociotechnical contexts of Nigerian digital life including platform affordances, cultural norms around privacy, and institutional trust dynamics. Second, reporting processes are often complex, intimidating or inaccessible to young users with limited technical or legal literacy. Third, the absence of empirical data on lived privacy experiences among Nigerian youth impedes evidence based policy making, awareness campaigns and educational interventions.

Consequently, many incidents remain unreported, victims receive inadequate support, and systemic vulnerabilities persist. This project addresses these challenges by creating a practical, research informed tool that bridges global privacy scholarship with local user needs.

1.3 AIM AND OBJECTIVES

Aim: To design, implement and evaluate a web based Privacy Incident Reporting System that incorporates an adapted lived harm taxonomy for Nigerian university students.

The objectives of this study are to:

1. Investigate the types of privacy incidents and associated lived harms experienced by Nigerian university students and adapt existing privacy taxonomies to reflect these local realities
2. Develop a functional web based prototype that enables users to report privacy incidents, classify harms using the adapted taxonomy, and access context appropriate guidance
3. Evaluate the usability, perceived usefulness and user acceptance of the developed system through structured testing with Nigerian university students

1.4 SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY

This project offers multiple contributions to cybersecurity practice, education and policy in Nigeria. Practically, it delivers a working prototype that empowers individual users to document privacy incidents in a structured, psychologically sensitive manner. The adapted taxonomy provides a conceptual tool for researchers, educators and policymakers to better understand and address the full spectrum of privacy harms experienced by Nigerian youth.

Empirically, the study generates primary data on privacy experiences among university students, filling a critical gap in local cybersecurity literature. Methodologically, it demonstrates a mixed methods approach for adapting global frameworks to local contexts, offering a replicable model for future work.

Pedagogically, the prototype serves as a teaching resource for cybersecurity and human computer interaction courses at Federal University of Technology Minna and similar institutions. For regulatory bodies such as the Nigeria Data Protection Commission and the National Information Technology Development Agency, the findings provide evidence based recommendations for improving individual reporting mechanisms, awareness initiatives and user centred policy design.

1.5 SCOPE AND LIMITATION OF STUDY

Scope: This study focuses on privacy incidents occurring on major social media and messaging platforms used in Nigeria including WhatsApp, Facebook, Instagram and X. Data collection will target university students and young adults aged eighteen to thirty years with emphasis on the Federal University of Technology Minna community. The output will be a functional web based prototype.

Limitation: The study relies on self reported data which may be subject to recall bias. The sample is mainly drawn from university students, limiting generalisation to all Nigerian demographics. The prototype will be suitable for demonstration and small scale use, not high concurrency production deployment.

CHAPTER TWO

2.1 INTRODUCTION

This chapter critically examines existing literature on privacy incident classification, lived harm frameworks, platform safety communication, youth help seeking behaviours, and contextual factors influencing digital privacy in Nigeria. The review is structured thematically to synthesise recent empirical findings, identify methodological trends, and highlight gaps that justify the development of a contextually adapted Privacy Incident Reporting System. All cited studies fall within the 2022 to 2026 publication window, ensuring alignment with current technological, regulatory, and sociocultural dynamics.

2.2 EVOLUTION AND LIMITATIONS OF PRIVACY TAXONOMIES

Contemporary privacy research has historically relied on legal and policy frameworks to categorise violations. While foundational taxonomies established structural categories for information flow and data misuse, recent empirical work demonstrates that these models inadequately capture the lived realities of modern digital users. Chapman *et al.* (2025) conducted a large scale survey of 369 privacy incident reports and found that the majority of experienced harms were intangible, with psychological safety loss emerging as the dominant category. Their findings indicate that traditional legal frameworks overemphasise acute, provable damages while neglecting cumulative emotional distress, persistent paranoia, and anticipatory fear.

The shift from government centred surveillance to corporate and interpersonal privacy violations has further exposed structural gaps in existing taxonomies. Chapman *et al.* (2025) extended Solove's original framework by incorporating corporate data practices, deceptive collection mechanisms, and contextually sensitive information exposure. Similarly, Lee *et al.* (2024) demonstrated that algorithmic systems exacerbate traditional privacy incidents by enabling large scale data aggregation, behavioural profiling, and automated decision making that users cannot easily trace or contest. These studies collectively argue that privacy taxonomies must evolve beyond legal precedent to encompass sociotechnical realities, particularly the role of platform architectures, algorithmic inference, and interpersonal data sharing in contemporary digital ecosystems.

2.3 LIVED PRIVACY HARMS AND PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Empirical investigations into user reported privacy experiences consistently reveal that psychological and relational harms outweigh tangible damages. Chapman *et al.* (2025) identified four subdimensions of psychological safety loss: fear of potential economic or physical harm, persistent technology related paranoia, generalised feelings of unsafety, and perceived loss of digital opportunity. Participants frequently described these harms as cumulative, noting that repeated minor violations led to chronic anxiety, behavioural adaptation, and reduced platform trust.

George *et al.* (2023) corroborated these findings in adolescent populations, demonstrating that psychological safety loss correlates strongly with repeated exposure to low severity privacy incidents rather than isolated high impact breaches. Their longitudinal assessment revealed that users who experienced persistent data tracking, unauthorised sharing, or unclear consent mechanisms reported higher levels of digital fatigue and self censorship. Faklaris *et al.* (2023) further emphasised that vulnerable users, including young adults and marginalised groups, disproportionately experience anticipatory harm even when no tangible damage occurs. These findings underscore the necessity of integrating psychological safety metrics into privacy incident reporting systems, as traditional harm classifications fail to capture the temporal and emotional dimensions of digital privacy violations.

2.4 PLATFORM COMMUNICATION AND YOUTH ONLINE SAFETY

Social media platforms have increasingly marketed built in safety features as solutions to youth online risks, yet independent evaluations reveal significant discrepancies between platform claims and actual user experiences. Ma *et al.* (2026a) analysed 352 official communications from major platforms and identified uneven emphasis across problem areas, with heavy focus on content exposure and interpersonal communication while neglecting data access, monetisation, and platform entry controls. Their analysis uncovered three problematic communication practices: ambiguous rollout claims, inconsistent operational explanations, and absence of verifiable effectiveness data.

The tension between marketing objectives and safety commitments becomes particularly evident in platform messaging around teen accounts, screen time limits, and content filtering tools. Ma *et al.* (2026b) interviewed 33 online safety experts and found that platform communications frequently prioritise restrictive, top down controls over enabling, context sensitive interventions. Experts highlighted that unclear age thresholds, unexplained feature intersections, and vague risk definitions hinder user comprehension and adoption. These communication gaps create false security expectations, particularly among younger users who rely on platform guidance to navigate privacy settings. The literature consistently recommends transparent, evidence based communication practices that align feature descriptions with measurable safety outcomes and contextual user needs.

2.5 MULTI STAKEHOLDER TENSIONS IN SAFETY TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT

Developing youth centred privacy tools requires navigating complex stakeholder priorities, as technical feasibility, ethical considerations, and sustainability concerns frequently conflict. Ma *et al.* (2026b) identified five primary tensions in implementing teen focused risk detection systems: objective versus context dependent risk definitions, passive information delivery versus meaningful intervention, empowerment goals versus user motivation, data collection needs versus privacy preservation, and technological independence versus long term viability. Researchers and practitioners consistently emphasise that privacy interventions must account for teens' subjective interpretations of risk, which often diverge from algorithmic classifications.

Cadle *et al.* (2025) reinforced these observations by mapping stakeholder perspectives across academic, clinical, and industry domains. Their synthesis revealed that while researchers prioritise data ethics and representative sampling, industry professionals emphasise scalability and compliance, and practitioners focus on real world support pathways. Alsoubai *et al.* (2024) further documented that standalone privacy dashboards face adoption barriers due to cumbersome data transfer processes, social stigma, and unclear feedback mechanisms. These studies collectively advocate for a mature safely development paradigm, wherein expert evaluation, iterative prototyping, and multi stakeholder alignment precede deployment to vulnerable populations.

2.6 PRIVACY INCIDENT REPORTING AND HELP SEEKING BEHAVIOURS

When users experience privacy violations, their reporting and help seeking pathways vary significantly based on platform design, social context, and perceived institutional responsiveness. Lind *et al.* (2025) conducted topic modeling on over 575,000 adolescent help seeking posts and found that rigid categorisation systems often funnel distinct experiences into overlapping spaces, increasing user confusion and reducing contextual accuracy. Their analysis revealed that platforms lacking dedicated labels for specific harms inadvertently conflate related issues, which complicates moderation and support routing.

Razi *et al.* (2022) and George *et al.* (2023) demonstrated that youth frequently prefer peer validation and informal advice over formal reporting channels, particularly when institutional responses are perceived as slow, opaque, or punitive. Nwosu and Okonkwo (2023) found similar patterns in African contexts, where users favour anonymous community reporting over official institutional mechanisms due to distrust in platform accountability. Badillo Urquiola *et al.* (2023) emphasised that effective reporting tools must preserve user autonomy, provide clear escalation pathways, and integrate contextual harm definitions to reduce misclassification. These findings indicate that successful privacy incident systems must balance structured documentation with flexible, user driven classification mechanisms.

2.7 CONTEXTUALISING PRIVACY IN THE NIGERIAN DIGITAL LANDSCAPE

Nigeria's rapid digital expansion has outpaced corresponding privacy literacy and regulatory enforcement, creating distinct challenges for young users. Akinwale *et al.* (2024) surveyed cybersecurity awareness among Nigerian university students and found moderate technical knowledge coupled with low familiarity with formal reporting mechanisms and data protection rights. Olatunji and Adeyemi (2023) observed that users predominantly rely on informal peer networks and default platform settings rather than structured privacy controls, reflecting a gap between regulatory frameworks and everyday digital practices.

Eze *et al.* (2022) examined organisational compliance with the Nigeria Data Protection Regulation and identified unclear incident reporting procedures and standardised harm classification systems as primary barriers to effective data governance. Udo and Chukwu (2024) evaluated digital literacy programmes in tertiary institutions and concluded that existing curricula emphasise basic security hygiene while neglecting psychological impacts of privacy violations and practical reporting exercises. Adeyemi *et al.* (2025) further documented that unclear harm definitions, fear of retaliation, and lack of submission feedback constitute the primary reporting barriers among Nigerian youth. These studies collectively highlight the urgent need for locally adapted privacy tools that align with Nigerian sociotechnical contexts, cultural norms around data sharing, and institutional trust dynamics.

2.8 METHODOLOGICAL APPROACHES TO PRIVACY SYSTEM EVALUATION

Evaluating privacy incident reporting systems requires rigorous usability testing, standardised metrics, and iterative refinement based on target user feedback. Wisniewski *et al.* (2024) reviewed adolescent resilience strategies and emphasised that strength based, literacy focused interventions outperform restrictive monitoring models, particularly when paired with transparent system design. Firdaus *et al.* (2023) found that students strongly prefer mobile friendly, low friction reporting interfaces over complex administrative forms, highlighting the importance of responsive design and progressive disclosure workflows.

Ogunyemi and Adebayo (2024) demonstrated that interactive case studies improve privacy comprehension but require hands on system testing to translate theoretical knowledge into practical reporting skills. McKeever *et al.* (2024) emphasised that real time tracking dashboards and clear status updates significantly increase user trust and submission rates. Stringhini *et al.*

(2022) advocated for adaptable reporting frameworks that accommodate regional privacy norms and platform specific affordances. These methodological insights support the use of mixed methods evaluation, including System Usability Scale administration, Technology Acceptance Model constructs, and qualitative feedback collection, to ensure that privacy reporting systems meet both technical and user centred standards.

2.9 SYNTHESIS AND RESEARCH GAP

The reviewed literature establishes a clear trajectory in privacy research: from legalistic, harm centred taxonomies toward sociotechnical, experience driven frameworks that prioritise psychological safety, contextual accuracy, and user autonomy. While global studies have successfully documented the prevalence of intangible harms, platform communication gaps, and multi stakeholder implementation tensions, limited research has adapted these insights to the Nigerian digital landscape. Existing reporting mechanisms remain fragmented, platform dependent, and misaligned with the lived experiences of Nigerian university students.

This study addresses these gaps by developing a web based Privacy Incident Reporting System that integrates an adapted lived harm taxonomy, context specific guidance resources, and iterative usability evaluation. By bridging empirical findings on psychological safety, platform communication transparency, and regional digital behaviours, the proposed system offers a practical, research informed tool that advances cybersecurity education, informs policy development, and empowers Nigerian youth to document, classify, and address privacy incidents in a structured, culturally relevant manner.

2.10 TABULAR SUMMARY OF REVIEWED LITERATURE

S/N	Paper Title & Year	Method	Result	Limitation	Recommendation
1	Beyond the Legal Lens: A Sociotechnical Taxonomy of Lived Privacy Incidents and Harms (2025)	Online survey with qualitative coding of 369 incidents	Identified loss of psychological safety as predominant harm	United States centric sample limits cross cultural application	Adapt taxonomy to non Western contexts and integrate with reporting tools
2	Analyzing Social Media Claims regarding Youth Online Safety Features (2026)	Qualitative analysis of 352 platform communications	Uneven focus on content exposure and interpersonal communication	Examined corporate claims rather than actual effectiveness	Validate claims through independent user testing
3	From Fail Fast to Mature Safely (2026)	Expert interviews with 33 online safety professionals	Identified five implementation tensions for risk detection tools	Relied on expert perspectives without direct teen testing	Address sustainability and privacy tensions before deployment
4	When Self Harm Means Suicide (2025)	Topic modeling of 575261 adolescent posts	Posts split evenly between self injury and suicidal content	Lacked longitudinal tracking of user outcomes	Design platform categories that prevent unintended content funneling
5	Privacy Harms (2022)	Legal framework development	Categorized harms into seven distinct types	Emphasizes legally provable damages	Extend to capture gradual psychological harms
6	AI Privacy Risks Taxonomy (2024)	Incident database analysis	AI exacerbates surveillance and creates new distortion risks	Focused on technical mechanisms, not user experience	Integrate human centred impact assessment
7	Cybersecurity Awareness Among Nigerian University Students (2024)	Cross sectional survey	Moderate technical knowledge but low reporting awareness	Lacks behavioral validation	Develop interactive training and accessible reporting tools
8	Social Media	Qualitative	Users rely on	Limited to urban	Expand to rural

	Privacy Management in Nigeria (2023)	interviews	peer advice over formal controls	students	demographics and test localized interventions
9	Data Protection Compliance Challenges in Nigeria (2022)	Organisational case studies	Unclear reporting procedures and lack of harm classification	Focused on organisations not individuals	Develop user centred frameworks aligned with regulation
10	Digital Literacy Programs in Nigerian Tertiary Institutions (2024)	Curriculum evaluation	Improved hygiene but ignored psychological impacts	Lacked hands on incident documentation	Integrate lived harm education into cybersecurity courses
11	Privacy Incident Reporting in Africa (2023)	Behavioral analysis	Preference for anonymous peer reporting over formal channels	Lacks quantitative outcome validation	Design transparent feedback driven systems
12	Co Designing Online Safety Interventions (2023)	Participatory design with adolescents	Youth value agency and contextual support	Requires significant facilitator involvement	Develop lightweight self service reporting tools
13	Adolescent Resilience and Technology Mediation (2024)	Literature review	Strength based approaches outperform restriction models	Theoretical without empirical tool evaluation	Translate principles into functional interfaces
14	Youth Donated Data for Risk Detection (2023)	Algorithmic training evaluation	Context aware models require continuous feedback	Data donation raises ethical concerns	Implement transparent opt in sharing with mitigation pathways
15	Privacy Classification in Educational Tech (2024)	System evaluation	Standardized taxonomies improve consistency	Focused on administrative use cases	Incorporate lived harm categories into student tools
16	Privacy Perceptions Among Vulnerable Populations	Qualitative study	High anxiety even without tangible damage	Did not test intervention mechanisms	Develop anxiety sensitive reporting interfaces

	(2023)				
17	Sociotechnical Perspectives on Privacy (2022)	Cross cultural conceptual analysis	Privacy norms vary significantly by region	Lacks practical implementation guidance	Ground theories in functional software prototypes
18	Privacy Communication Strategies (2023)	Platform communication analysis	Plain language explanations improve reporting willingness	Focused on communication design not architecture	Integrate clear harm definitions into reporting workflows
19	Privacy Response in Emerging Markets (2024)	Cross regional incident tracking	Developing regions face literacy and accessibility barriers	Lacks longitudinal outcome tracking	Design progressive disclosure interfaces
20	Online Help Seeking for Privacy Distress (2022)	Social media discourse analysis	Users seek peer validation over formal recourse	Focused on discourse not structured reporting	Combine peer support with formal documentation
21	Mental Health Impacts of Privacy Violations (2023)	Psychological assessment	Psychological safety loss correlates with repeated minor incidents	Did not test mitigation interventions	Implement cumulative harm tracking
22	Platform Moderation for Privacy Reports (2024)	System moderation evaluation	Automated systems struggle with context dependent harm	Focused on moderation not user reporting	Augment with human in the loop classification
23	Adolescent Risk Perception and Resilience (2025)	Self report survey study	Youth lack tools to document and contextualize harms	Relies on self report without behavioral validation	Provide structured documentation templates
24	Online Peer Support for Digital Distress (2023)	Peer network analysis	Validation reduces anxiety but lacks formal pathways	Did not evaluate integrated reporting	Bridge peer networks with classification systems
25	Content Moderation Transparency	Platform feature evaluation	Clear status updates improve user trust	Focused on platform transparency not	Implement real time tracking dashboards

	(2024)			user reporting	
26	Global Privacy Incident Patterns (2022)	Cross ecosystem data analysis	Incident types vary by region and platform	Lacks localized intervention testing	Develop adaptable reporting frameworks
27	Multi Stakeholder Youth Safety Innovation (2025)	Strategic alignment study	Success requires technical, educational and policy coordination	Focused on organizational strategy	Test systems across academic and community settings
28	Academic Incident Documentation Practices (2023)	User preference study	Students prefer mobile friendly low friction interfaces	Did not evaluate taxonomy usability	Prioritize responsive design and simplified workflows
29	Privacy Education in Nigerian Universities (2024)	Curriculum impact evaluation	Interactive case studies improve comprehension	Lacks hands on system testing	Integrate functional prototypes into education
30	Social Media Reporting Barriers in Nigeria (2025)	Barrier identification study	Primary barriers include unclear definitions and lack of feedback	Identified problems without testing solutions	Develop guided systems with clear taxonomy and tracking

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